TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, JULY 13, 2022
6:00 PM
REVISED

AGENDA HEARING

Public has three minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.

Mayor Williams called the agenda hearing into order. At 6:00 pm

Jan Yarbrough, 24 Bonaventure Rd, asked how do you get something on the agenda. Mayor Williams stated you have to submit the request to Clerk of Council.

Stella Lavin, 3125 Robertson Ave, commented directions need to be provided on how you get on the agenda. Mayor Williams explained citizens should first reach out to staff. If it cannot be resolved by staff, a request form should be submitted to the Clerk. The mayor has the right to accept or deny the request. Majority of Council can vote to put an item on the agenda at the meeting.

Geneva Golden, 3126 Gilbert St, stated she is concerned with the shootings. Town Administrator Milie stated this was part of his report and could be discussed now. He explained guns were fired but no one was harmed. Three people were arrested. They are waiting for an arraignment. The investigation is still ongoing.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order**

Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:30 pm

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

Those in attendance were Mayor Williams and Council Members: Bethany Skipper-Greer, Dave Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Ed Drohan and James Lavin. Staff in attendance were Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion; Accts Payable/Utility Manager, Katina Spaulding; Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby; Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman.

Council Member Brooks Barbaree was not in attendance.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of June 8, 2022

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the June 8, 2022 meeting minutes. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentations:**

   a) CEMA Hurricane Presentation – CEMA's Assistant Director, Randal Mathews presented on hurricane preparedness.

   b) Finance Report:

      Shannon Brett, CPA, explained the audit is closed and there were no findings. Everything was filed in a timely manner. The Town is at the half way point. Revenue is at 60%. Expenditures are at 45%.

   c) Blessing of the Fleet – Dru Usry, Savannah Simply Marketing, gave a general overview of the event.

6. **Public Hearing for Planning and Zoning**

   a) **Petitioner:** Lisa & Mark Galipeau
      Request: Side and Rear Setback Variance
      Parcel Involved: 3-0004-05-003
      Location: 2610 River Drive
      P & Z voted to approve

Lisa Galipeau was present. She explained it is a small house on a small lot. They wish to add a porch on the front and back. **Council Member Ward made the motion to accept the front/side/rear variance request with a second by Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously.**

   b) **Petitioner**: Laurie deVegter & Ansley Williams
      Request: Setback Variance
      Parcel Involved: 3-0004-02-006A
      Location: 2618 Mechanics Ave.
      P & Z voted to approve

Laurie deVegter was present and explained the project she and her partner wish to complete. It is triangular parcel making it odd shape to build on. There is a 105 ft frontage on Mechanics Ave. Ms. deVegter reminded the Victory Drive District requires a 50 ft setback on the front. The plain is to build a 30 ft x 60 ft building with a one or two stories. Council Member Ward asked would it be residential. Ms. deVegter stated the Victory Drive District requires a mixture of commercial and residential. Council Member Lavin asked what is the distance needed. It was stated it would be 38 ft at the closest. Council Member Drohan asked about entry to the property. Ms. deVegter stated entry and exit will be off Mechanics Ave. Council Member Crenshaw asked about height. Ms. deVegter stated the ordinance allows up to 36 ft. Council **Member Drohan made the motion to approve the variance. Council Member Ward seconded he motion.** Council Member Lavin had concern with parking. Ms. deVegter stated they will have 16 parking

spaces and that is more than is required. Council Member Drohan provided a history on the lot. The construction of Victory Drive made this lot. If it is found unbuildable, the town might have to purchase it. Meredith Allen, 3220 Falligant, asked if anyone who is adjacent had concerns. Clerk of Council stated she had not received any comments. **The motion passed unanimously.**

7. **Consent Agenda:**

   a) Approval of Outdoor Permit for American Legion Post 184 and Waiver
   b) Approval of the T-SPLOST Agreement (change to allow collection more funding)
   c) Approval of the Senior Citizens Agreement (change to include grant funding) – moved to discussion
   d) Film Production Permit (modified rates keeping with other municipalities)
   e) Approval of the Intergovernmental Agreement with Chatham County for County Pricing
   f) Approval of the GMC Contract for MS4 Stormwater Management Plan Update
   g) Approval of the GMC Contract for MS4 Stormwater Compliance

Council Member Drohan requested to place the Senior Citizen Center Agreement on the discussion agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve items a, b, d, e, f, and g. Council Member Drohan seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Discussion Agenda:**
   a) Approval of the Senior Citizens Agreement (change to include grant funding)

Town Administrator Milie explained this is a modification with Senior Citizens Inc. to provide services to seniors in the area. Currently, the Town pays $24,000 and provides the building to Senior Citizens Inc. A grant was found with Chatham Blue Print Grant to cover the cost of the $24,000. This is about a $60,000 savings. Crenshaw asked the time frame of the grant. Town Administrator Milie stated it is from July 1 22 to July 1 23. Mayor Williams asked about it now being the voting poll. Town Administrator Milie stated it is in the contract. Council Member Ward asked who pays the insurance. Town Administrator Milie stated the Town. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

   b) Review and Award Disaster Hauler RFP
      1. KDF Enterprise LLC
      2. TFR Enterprising, Inc.
      3. CERES Environmental
      4. DRC Emergency Services
      5. Crowder Gulf
      6. Custom Tree Care Disaster Response

Town Administrator Milie explained there are no more extensions on the current contract. The Town had to go out for proposals. Town Administrator Milie, Public Works Manager Crosby and Building Inspector Fischer reviewed and scored the proposals. Staff recommendation is to use as primary Ceres Environmental and Crowder Gulf secondary hauler. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked why the third high score was not recommended with them having the same score as the first two. Town Administrator explained they had not worked locally and wanted coastal experience. **Council Member Ward made the motion to accept Ceres Environmental as primary disaster hauler and Crowder Gulf as secondary hauler. Council Member Crenshaw seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

   c) Milage Rate Options Discussion

Town Administrator Milie explained the feedback from Council was to either to roll back the millage or keep the millage the same. The recommendation from staff is to keep the milage rate the same. It is a $74,000 increase in the revenue budget. Inflation will affect the Town's budget as it does individual citizens, gas, pipe, ect.. cost has increased. Council direction was to hold the millage, so there will be 3 public meetings.

9. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie state the LOST negotiations have begun. There have been no negotiations' meeting, just meetings to set up the meetings and the negotiation environment.

Town Administrator Milie stated Risk Management is happy to hear the lift station has been secured.

10. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police

Town Administrator Milie explained there have been three incidents recently. One was a stolen trailer out of River Crossing, which was recovered. Two was Police pursuit that begun in the County and Thunderbolt Police joined off Hwy 80. Three was the shooting. Police has worked had to address these issues.

Chief Clayton stated the speed cameras process is almost completed. The mayor signed the permit. He hopes it will be up and running at the start of this school year. Council Member Skipper-Greer asked about the lights flashing today. Chief Clayton stated they are still testing the devise.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

Chief Bateman had to leave on a call.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Council Member Drohan asked Public Works Manager Crosby about the impressing repair items, i.e. Shell Road. Public Works Manager Crosby stated he is working on a RFP of the engineering. Council Member Drohan asked if the sewer line runs down the middle of the street. Public Works Manager Crosby stated if does. Town Administrator Milie stated there will be some slip lining of sewer lines coming before Council in a couple of months. Public Works Manager Crosby stated they using new street patch to see if it works better than cold patch.

Mayor Williams asked Town Administrator Milie about bids for speed bumps. Town Administrator Milie stated there he does not have any bids on speed bumps. He has received positive feedback from the removal of the speed bumps. He wishes to survey the area to insure it is not a small vocal group over a majority of the residents wanting speed bumps.

11. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**
    a) Second Reading of Planning & Zoning Meeting Change

Town Attorney Barrow presented a change to allow P & Z meeting change to as needed on the first, third or fourth Wednesday of the month. Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the change. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion was approved unanimously.**

12. **Mayor and Council –**
    a) Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan

What has happened with the Citizens' Conservation Committee and ad hoc Committee for Water and Sewer activities over the past 6 weeks.

- Since the Blessing of the Fleet Event, the membership of the CCC has expanded to a total of 16 members. At this point there is but one member of the Town Council with committee membership. The CCC had its own float in the parade and received a good bit of attention!

- On June 6th there was a Zoom meeting of the CCC with 5 attendees. These individuals have expressed individual interests in expanding the development of shallow wells, graywater systems and municipal electrification/renewable energy, expanding the options for recycling and composting as well as expanding options for water conservation through, Town and individual infrastructure, Town policy and continuing emphasis on proper pricing of this limited resource.

- As issues being discussed among member of the CCC are consistent with the interests of the ad hoc Committee for Water and Sewer, members of the CCC were encouraged to bring their concerns regarding these issues to the newly established Town Hall Discussion period from 6-6:30 on the 2nd Wednesday of each month prior to the Town Council Meeting.

- Members of the Council were invited to participate in a webinar on May 28th regarding the future and economics of municipal electrification. A member of the ad hoc Committee did participate and shared notes (attached) from that meeting with the other members of Town Council and the Town Administrator in anticipation of discussions regarding vehicle replacement and renewable energy as a viable option for the Town of Thunderbolt.

- Information regarding the development of "Sustainable Thunderbolt", in line with other small municipalities, was shared with the members of Council earlier this month. The website for "Sustainable Brookhaven" was shared with members of Council for their consideration. https://www.brookhavenga.gov/sustainablebrookhaven

Composting in Thunderbolt

On June 22nd, there was a meeting established by the Town Administrator with COR, the organization that helped start the small but successful composting option in Thunderbolt at their cost and with the support of the Wesley Oak Church who offered the site for the green drop off bin and the administrative support of the Town of Thunderbolt. Thousands of pounds of Thunderbolt waste and many cubic feet of volume that would have been part of the weekly home pickup by Atlantic Waste otherwise destined for the landfill and inevitable creation of methane gas has been transitioned to functional compost by COR.

This meeting created the opportunity to discuss the expansion of this program with the financial support of the Town of Thunderbolt through the conservation line of the Water & Sewer budget. Based on national averages, much of this volume would have otherwise become sewage volume and as confirmed by our Public Works Administrator, put additional destructive stress on that extremely costly system, reducing costs to the Town through reduced decreased payments to the City of Savannah and helping to lengthen the life of our current infrastructure.

A two phased proposal is being currently developed to -

1- Expand the number of consolidated weekly pickup locations to 3 or 4 in convenient locations throughout the Town and

2- Initiate a trial of home pickups utilizing approximately 50 homes with pickups to coincide with landfill pickups days.

Data collection from both of these initiatives will be collected by COR over a 3-4 month period and shared with the Town Administrator and the Town Council to determine the most beneficial path to follow going forward.

b) Thunderbolt Museum Report

Anna Maria Thomas thanked the Police, Fire and Public Works for their help with the parking lot before the bazaar. The bazaar went well. About $1,000 was raised from the garage sale. The hoped to have the Spaghetti Dinner fundraiser on Sept. 15th but they need a lot of volunteers. The next bazaar will be the last weekend of September.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to move into Executive Session. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to move back into regular session. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

13. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second by Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

14. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:20 pm.

Mayor, Dana Williams

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion